

BIO

AUBRIÉ COSTELLO is a queer visual artist, creative & film director, writer, and curator of multimedia collaborations in Philadelphia, PA. Their collaborative projects amalgamate fiber art, photography, film, fashion, original music, literary/performance/installation art, and community care. They explore, depict and celebrate their creative collaborators' unique experiences through varied media. They are co-creating artful resources and safe spaces for their community members to rediscover vulnerability, express themselves fully, and be seen with dignity. They chronicle the often unseen, intimate moments, and nuanced emotions experienced within our most personal relationships with self and others. The intention behind their work is to create experiences which encourage community engagement, interaction, self reflection, self-love, and thoughtful collaboration. Their work centers BIPOC AAPI LGBTQIA2S+ narratives.

Costello's oeuvre is rooted in accessible, large-scale text-based fiber art installations called "silk graffiti" in public spaces. As a visual artist, Costello creates tangible fiber art objects and costumes featuring poignant silk graffiti text which reflects and conveys a particular, often shared, moment in time. The objects exist as props for collaborators to wear and interact with, then transform into curios which they later repurpose, reconfigure, and reutilize in site-specific installations and live experiences. Costello has expanded into the roles of creative director and film director, envisioning and producing multidisciplinary work, specifically films, performances, and literary projects. They invite creative contributors to infuse their craft(s) and perspective(s) into each collaboration. These works across art forms center the robust, vital, resonating queer stories of their collaborators, and further contextualize the silk words by investigating the meaning and impact of the text on the body and in space. Costello's work explores the tension between what's kept private versus what's shared publicly and investigates how, when our private emotions are revealed in safe spaces with care, transparency, and without shame, opportunities to more deeply understand ourselves, one another, and our interconnectedness present themselves. These understandings could yield mindful, holistic consideration and collective mutual care, resulting in a more honest, equitable, and abundant society. Costello's work surveys softness as resistance and softness as protest of the internalized hardening and desensitization we continually learn and habitually exhibit. Their work is an offering to explore the value and transformative power of vulnerability, softness, gentleness, and eroticism beyond only the sexual, and how each can act as a conduit for our collective healing from the consistent harm and trauma we're navigating.

Costello has exhibited their work extensively in Philadelphia and abroad, most notably at the Philadelphia Museum of Art, Asian Arts Initiative, Philadelphia City Hall, Fairmount Water Works, Philadelphia International Airport, International House University of Pennsylvania, Chemical Heritage Foundation (now Science History Institute), Moore College of Art & Design, Main Line Arts Center, Bucks County Community College Hicks Art Center Gallery, The James Oliver Gallery, Projects Gallery, in politically and socially charged exhibitions Truth To Power, Into Action and WE RISE in Philadelphia, Los Angeles, & Chicago. Costello was a co-organizer of the 2017 citywide public art project, Signs Of Solidarity, and is a co-founder of anonymous public art curatorial collective Group X. Costello's work was featured in all 10 episodes of SMILF S2 on Showtime. Their self-published SOFT Book & their latest literary offering, the FEEL Deck, are currently on view & stocked at Ulises in Philadelphia and Other Nature in Berlin, Germany. The FEEL Deck is also featured in all suites and the AWAY Spa at W Philadelphia luxury hotel.

EDUCATION

2007 BFA, Moore College of Art and Design, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

EXHIBITIONS

- 2025 Philadelphia Museum of Art, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
THE EROTIC PROJECT Takeover
- 2025 Other Nature, Berlin, Germany
THE EROTIC PROJECT / FEEL
- 2025 v.Lo, Copenhagen, Denmark
FEEL Reveal
- 2025 Blah Blah Gallery
FEEL Reveal
- 2024 Ulises, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
FEEL Reveal
- 2024 Resolution Studios, Chicago, Illinois
INTO ACTION 2024
- 2024 Wilma Theatre, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Invisible Ink
- 2023 Asian Arts Initiative, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
THE EROTIC PROJECT Exhibition 2020-2023
- 2022 Fairmount Water Works, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
POOL: A Social History Of Segregation
- 2022 W Hotel Philadelphia, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
THE EROTIC PROJECT Feel Shorts Program
- 2020 Philadelphia International Airport, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
WE WERE ONE, THAT'S WHEN, + WE FLEW
- 2019 Ubiq, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
THAT'S WHEN WE FLEW
- 2019 Los Angeles, California
WE RISE (2018 & 2019)
- 2018 Los Angeles, California
Into Action!
- 2018 Amie Potsic Art Advisory LLC & Space and Company, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Donald Camp, Tom Judd, & Aubrie Costello: Decorous
- 2018 Kimmel Center For The Performing Arts, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
MCAD Alumni Exhibition
- 2017 Science History Institute (Chemical Heritage Foundation), Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Things Fall Apart: The Decay Project
- 2017 Main Line Arts Center, Haverford, Pennsylvania
Happily Ever After
- 2017 990 Spring Garden, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
More Is Contained Than What Is Revealed

EXHIBITIONS continued

- 2017 City Hall, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Message To Our Daughters
- 2016 Little Berlin, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Philadelphia, Goddamn - Art in Dissent
- 2016 990 Spring Garden, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Truth To Power
- 2015 Gravy Studio, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Brae Howard & Aubrie Costello: Portrait Of A Woman
- 2014 BCCC Hicks Art Center Gallery, Newtown, Pennsylvania
R/W: Reading & Writing Visual Experience
- 2013 The International House at University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
SHE WANTED THE WORLD / SHE WANTED OUT
- 2013 The James Oliver Gallery, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Illumination
- 2012 Paradigm Gallery, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Ladylike
- 2010 Moore College of Art and Design, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
The Other Woman + The Philadelphia Ten: Collectively Speaking
- 2010 Projects Gallery, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
It's Who You Know
- 2009 Projects Gallery, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Summer In The City
- 2008 Projects Gallery, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Paper
- 2007 Kelly & Weber Fine Art, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
The Other Woman
- 2007 POST Group Exhibition, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
The Other Woman Curated by Eileen Tognini
- 2007 Mew Gallery, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Debutante Set

COLLABORATIONS

- 2025 FEEL x W Philadelphia Hotel, Philadelphia, PA
- 2024 Invisible Ink THE EROTIC PROJECT x Pig Iron Theatre Co. companion to "Poor Judge" Philadelphia Fringe Festival 2024 Wilma Theater, Philadelphia, PA
- 2024 Mirror Mirror for Nicki Minaj Pink Friday 2 Tour & "Most Wanted" for Bad Bunny Most Wanted Tour Wells Fargo Center, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
- 2023 SOFT Book ft. over 40+ artists from Philadelphia, CDMX, LA, Portland OR, & Puerto Rico
- 2022 THE EROTIC PROJECT for Miguel Antonio Horn x Streets Dept Walls Design Philadelphia, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
- 2021 Feel Teaser ft. Ursula Rucker, Kingsley Ibeneche, Raquel Salas Rivera, Dáe Lee, Owlrare, Josh Hey, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
- 2019 KkCo x XOAC for Ubiq, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
- 2018 SMILF Season 2, 10 episodes, Showtime, Supahsmaht Productions, ABC Studios
- 2018 Trashcan Takeover, City Fitness & Rory Creative, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
- 2017 Show Me What You Want Me To See, Philadelphia Fringe Festival 2017, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
- 2017 Arts & Business Council of Greater Phila, ABC Awards 2017, Philadelphia Museum of Art
- 2017 The Versailles Luxury Apartments/Eileen Tognini Designs, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
- 2017 Signs Of Solidarity PHL/ATL, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania/Atlanta, Georgia
- 2016 Boyds Philadelphia, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
- 2016 Philadelphia Style Magazine, Best of Style, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
- 2016 Roche Bobois, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
- 2015 Dom Streater, New York Fashion Week, New York City, New York
- 2014 Esska Shoes, London, England

AFFILIATIONS

- 2018-2020 Group X / Co-founder
- 2017 Signs Of Solidarity / Co-founder
- 2006-11 The Other Woman (a ladies art collective) / Co-founder

LECTURES / PANEL DISCUSSIONS

- 2023 SOFT Book Reading & Film Screening Program at Asian Arts Initiative Philadelphia, PA
- 2017 Happily Ever After and the Female Gaze: Phila Women Artist Trailblazers - Then and Now, Main Line Art Center
- 2017 Hypebeast/Clarks Originals Artist Series, Ubiq, Philadelphia, PA
- 2017 Signs Of Solidarity & Mural Arts, The Art of Protest at The Kimmel Center, Phila, PA
- 2016 Little Berlin, Philadelphia, PA
- 2015 Gravy Studio & Gallery, Philadelphia, PA
- 2007 Kelly & Weber Fine Art, Philadelphia, PA
- 2006 Moore College of Art and Design, Philadelphia, PA

SELECT PRIVATE COLLECTORS

Joseph Ujobai, Exec VP/Head:Private Banking SEI Investments Canada Co, Chair National Portrait Gallery Board of Commissioners
 Eduardo Ardiles, Founder Studio Edo, Co-chair 2022 Portrait of a Nation Gala
 Frankie Shaw, Actor/Director/Writer Supahsmaht Productions
 Mia Moretti, International Poet & Music Producer
 Craig Grossman, General Partner Arts + Crafts Holdings
 The Civic, MM Partners/PSCo Philly

PRESS

The Artblog, Explore How Tenderness and Sexuality Intersect Through The Erotic Project's Publication (May 31, 2023) WHYY Website, Erotic art softens up Asian Arts Initiative (April 18, 2023) Philly.com & The Philadelphia Inquirer, Philly's Erotic Project makes art "eroticism for all." (April 10, 2023) Philadelphia International Airport website, Aubrie Costello WE WERE ONE, THAT'S WHEN, + WE FLEW (November 2019) The Fashionable Lampoon Magazine, Ephemeral Musings (September 2019) The Philadelphia Inquirer, New Season of SMILF features Philly artist's 'silk graffiti' (January 17, 2019) Chadds Ford Live, Mixed Media: Panoply of elements (September 13, 2018) WHYY Website, Trashcan Takeover Replaces ads with art on Philly cans (August 22, 2018) Philadelphia Curbed Website, 'Reclaiming Public Space': How Philadelphians turned ads into Art (August 21, 2018) Philly.com, #TrashcanTakeover pits local art against loud Barbera Ads (August 20, 2018) Billy Penn Website, Street Art Replaces Big Belly Advertising in Center City 'Trashcan Takeover' (August 20, 2018) City Suburban News, Artists Call for Social Justice and Question American Identity in 'Decorous' Exhibit (August 14, 2018) Hypebeast Website, A Look Inside the 'WE RISE' Pop-Up in Los Angeles (May 24, 2018) Martha Stewart Weddings Website, The Rustic California Wedding of Frankie Shaw and Zach Strauss (April 3, 2018) Art News, Into Action Pop-Up Show in Los Angeles (Dec 9, 2017) City Suburban Newspaper, Investigating The Female Gaze in "Happily Ever After" at the Main Line Art Center (Sept 20-26, 2017) Hypebeast, Embrace Your Artistic Abilities (October 17, 2017) Don Art News Website, Happily (October 2017) Rad Girls Philly Website, Meet Fiber Artist Aubrie Costello (Sept 12, 2017) Sticks + Stones Website, Q&A with Aubrie Costello (Sept 11, 2017) Time Out Philly Website and Magazine, Three new Philly street artists you should follow on Instagram (August 23, 2017) Fringe Arts Website, Whispers from the Wall: The Silk Graffiti of Aubrie Costello (August 4th, 2017) Cora Website, Fearless Female: Aubrie Costello (April 20, 2017) Hyperallergic Website, Artists Coordinate a Banner Drop Against Hate For Inaugural Weekend (Jan 19, 2017) Streets Dept Website, Top 10 Street Art Moments of 2016 (Dec 22, 2016) Philadelphia Style Magazine, Textual Healing (Winter/Holiday 2016) p. 76 WHYY Newsworks Website, Why Can't You Tell Me How You Feel? (November 28, 2016) Streets Dept Website, Aubrie Costello's Incredible New Installation (Nov 7, 2016) Moore College of Art & Design Website, Moore Alumna Named Heavy Hitter Artist in Philadelphia (Sept 28, 2016) Billy Penn Website, Who's Next: Arts (Sept 26, 2016) Streets Dept Website, Yes We Vote (Sept 2, 2016) Peopledelphia & Saxbys Coffee Website, Saxbys Stories: Aubrie Costello (Aug 10, 2016) Streets Dept Website, Aubrie Costello (July 26, 2016) Streets Dept Website, Installing Silk Graffiti on South Street with Aubrie Costello (July 15, 2016) Art In The Age Website, The Aura, Aubrie Costello (June 29, 2016) Philadelphia Style Website, Aubrie Costello on her Love Of Graffiti (June 23, 2016) Philadelphia Magazine Shoppist, Check Out This Beautiful Graffiti Made Out Of Silk (March 23, 2015) Vamp Footwear Website, Tag Team: Esska and XOAC Create Art for Fall '15 (Feb 6, 2015) Philadelphia Business Journal, Big Buzz About The Hive (Nov 15, 2014) Philly.com, Art, fashion, and rock join forces in local shows (April 25, 2014) Racked Philly Website, This Weekend's All About Craft Markets and Sidewalk Sales (April 24, 2014) Philadelphia Inquirer, Museum and gallery events (Dec 27, 2013) Philadelphia Inquirer, Museum and gallery events (Nov 29, 2013) University of Pennsylvania Almanac Website, December at Penn (Nov 26, 2013) Uwishunu Website, Tonight Picks (Oct 16, 2013) Visit Philly, Philly 360 Website, Silk Graffiti Collection: She Wanted The World/She Wanted Out Exhibit (Oct 14, 2013) Maniac Finds Website, Destroy Me, Discover Me (Sept 8 2013) Knight Arts Website, Unraveling "Illumination" at James Oliver Gallery easier said than done (Aug 1, 2013) Inliquid Website, Illumination (July 13, 2013) Uwishunu, A Fashion And Art Exhibit Arrives At The James Oliver Gallery (July 11, 2013) Philadelphia Weekly, Sisterly Affection on Display at Paradigm Gallery's "Ladylike" (Sept 12, 2012) Philadelphia City Paper, Style Maniac Blog, Silk Graffiti: A New Kind of Art from Aubrie Costello (May 7, 2012) For The Love of Shoes at Bus Stop (Feb 23, 2011) Beyond The Runway Philadelphia Fashion Blog, For The Love of Shoes: A Story of A Girl and Her Shoes (Feb 23, 2011) Ram Collective Blog, when I grow up... (Feb 4, 2011) Philly Fun Guide, Collectively Speaking Then and Now (June 2010) Philadelphia Examiner Website, Windows Throughout Old City (October 7, 2009) Philadelphia Daily Candy Website, Venus Envy, Aubrie Costello's Wall Objects (July 27, 2009) The Art Blog Website, First Friday-an introspective Fourth of July (July 7, 2009) Colored Thread Website, Summer In The City (June 25, 2009) The Philadelphia Inquirer, Hot Show: Summer In the City (Summer 2009) Philly2Philly Website, Petit Fours: A Lilliputian show of Miniatures (May 27, 2009) Moore News, Alumnae in Action (Winter 2008) Moore News, Transforming Hate (Feb 27, 2008) Helenair Website, Shedding Light on Hate (Jan 21, 2008) Daily Campello Art News Website, Paper at Projects Gallery (November 15, 2008) Mid Atlantic Arts News Website, The Other Woman (Nov 14, 2007) City Paper, Catch it or Regret it (Nov 1-8, 2007) p. 59 The Clog, It's beginning to look like Autumn (Nov 2, 2007) The Philadelphia Inquirer, Gallery Listings (Sept 28, 2007) Manufactured Dissent, Online arts magazine, Q&A with The Other Woman (October 3, 2007) Moore News, A Gallery of Their Own (Fall 2007) pp.18-19 201 Gallery Video by David Kessler (October 2007) Moore College of Art Website, News Section (October 30, 2007) Uwishunu Website, BUS STOP + Art (August 6, 2007) Joy Dilworth Website, BUS STOP + Art (July 23, 2007) Moore College of Art Website, News Section (March 1, 2007)

WORK

Founder / Creative Director

The Erotic Project | 2020 – Present

- Direct multidisciplinary collaborations across film, fiber art, performance, publishing, and installation.
- Produce SOFT (book) and FEEL (erotic prompt deck), self-published and stocked internationally at W Philadelphia Hotel, Ulises Books, Etc Etc, Other Nature alternativer Sexladen (Berlin), Paradigm Gallery, Casa Vida Boutique, and KkCo (LA).
- Develop branding, copywriting, digital marketing strategy, and project management for community-centered events.
- Manage collaborative teams of artists, performers, writers, and designers to execute immersive multimedia projects.

Visual Artist, Curator, and Film Director

Independent Practice | 2004 – Present

- Exhibit nationally and internationally at Philadelphia Museum of Art, Wilma Theater, Philadelphia International Airport, Ulises, Asian Arts Initiative, and INTO ACTION (LA/Chicago).
- Curate exhibitions and collaborative projects in Philadelphia and abroad, demonstrating range beyond public art collective Group X.
- Create large-scale silk graffiti fiber installations, costumes, performances, and films.
- Collaborate with cultural and fashion projects including SMILF (Showtime), Wells Fargo (Nicki Minaj “Pink Friday 2” Tour, Bad Bunny “Most Wanted” Tour), and W Hotel.
- Direct immersive, community-focused storytelling projects centering marginalized voices.

Stylist, Buyer, Branding & Creative Consultant

BUS STOP Boutique | 2007 – 2025

- 18-year affiliation with Philadelphia’s leading independent boutique.
- Styled and directed fashion campaigns and events; managed visual merchandising and creative direction.
- Developed digital marketing campaigns, Canva designs, copywriting, and brand storytelling.
- Supported community engagement initiatives and collaborative art/fashion projects.

EXPERIENCE

Fashion Stylist — International Projects

Independent Collaborations | 2014 – Present

- Styled campaigns and shows for designers and brands including Dom Streater (NY Fashion Week), Esska Shoes (London), and KkCo x XOAC (Ubiq, Philadelphia).
- Directed looks and creative branding for music, lifestyle, and fashion clients.
- Brought interdisciplinary, art-informed approach to styling, merging visual storytelling with brand identity.

Co-Founder / Curator

Group X | 2018 – 2020

- Produced large-scale public art projects with anonymous artist collective.
- Oversaw project management, branding, and community engagement strategies.
- Co-organized Signs of Solidarity, a citywide public art initiative in Philadelphia (2017).

Skills

- Creative Direction & Project Management
- Self-Publishing & Literary Production
- Fashion Styling: Local & International
- Designing & Buying
- Branding, Visual Merchandising & Digital Marketing
- Canva Design & Graphic Layouts
- Shopify & Klaviyo Administration
- SEO & Product Descriptions
- Copywriting & Copy Editing
- Exhibition Design & Curation
- Film & Video Production
- Fiber Art, Fine Art, & Public Installation
- Community Engagement & Collaborative Storytelling

Education

BFA, Moore College of Art and Design | Philadelphia, PA
2007

WEBSITES

AUBRIÉ COSTELLO | aubriecostello.com

FEEL DECK | thefeeldeck.com

THE EROTIC PROJECT | theeroticproject.com

A LITTLE BIT ABOUT AUBRIÉ

I am a multidisciplinary queer visual artist, creative director, writer, curator, branding specialist, buyer and stylist with 20 years of experience spanning visual & literary art, film, fashion branding, e-commerce, and digital marketing. My work blends creative brand storytelling, large-scale public art activations, exhibition design, and published projects with collaborative artworks that center queer marginalized BIPOC, AAPI, and LGBTQIA2S+ voices. I created THE EROTIC PROJECT, a robust ongoing multimedia healing-arts project featuring over 40 artists from all over the globe. I have conceived, styled, and directed creative campaigns for both local and international projects, including NY Fashion Week presentations, London Fashion Week guerrilla collaborations, and digital campaigns for music and lifestyle clients. With 20 years of strategizing, consulting, buying, designing, copywriting and editing, and curating creative campaigns and large-scale projects, I bring expertise in client relations, efficient project management, copywriting, editing, Shopify administration & Canva design, and community-focused inclusive, accessible, trauma-informed participatory programming. I have curated a multitude of exhibitions and projects in Philadelphia, LA, and internationally, creating immersive experiences that amplify nuanced voices, foster connection, and merge art, creative economy, and collaboration. I am also a self-publishing creator, producing an array of thoughtful original literary offerings for THE EROTIC PROJECT, like the 204 page SOFT Book and the 104 card FEEL Deck, both stocked at curated destinations such as W Philadelphia, Ulises Books, Etc Etc Books, queer-owned Other Nature alternativer Sexladen Berlin, Paradigm Gallery, Casa Vida Boutique, and KkCo Los Angeles.

AUBRIÉ IS A LOT OF THINGS

Collaborator, Creative Consultant, Project Manager, Client Relations, Copywriter, Visual Artist, Creative & Film Director, Curator, Stylist, Buyer, Branding, Administration, Design, E-commerce Specialist

CONTACT

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SKILLS

EDITORIAL STYLING

FILM & VIDEO PRODUCTION

COPYWRITING & COPY EDITING

ASSISTANT DESIGNING & BUYING

EXHIBITION DESIGN & CURATION

GRAPHIC DESIGN & CANVA LAYOUTS

PUBLISHING & LITERARY PRODUCTION

FIBER ART, FINE ART, & PUBLIC INSTALLATION

CREATIVE DIRECTION & PROJECT MANAGEMENT

BRANDING, VISUAL MERCHANDISING, & DIGITAL MARKETING

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT & COLLABORATIVE STORYTELLING